

Pelícano Peruano

Pelecanus thagus

The majestic Peruvian Pelican

It is a distinctive species from the South American Pacific coasts, especially from northern Chile to southern Ecuador. It is recognized by its large size, dark plumage with white and gray tones, and its characteristic white crest. Its long, colorful beak with an extendable pouch makes it unique among the seabirds of the region.



Master of fishing

The Peruvian pelican is famous for its fishing technique, which consists in diving from considerable heights to the sea in order to capture anchovies and small fish in its extendable pouch. This fishing method is essential for the health of marine ecosystems, helping to maintain their balance.

Natural Thermometer

They play a crucial ecological role in their habitat, as their presence is an indicator of the health of marine waters. In times of abundance, they are capable of forming large colonies that can include thousands of individuals. However, during the El Niño phenomenon, their population decreases due to the migration of fish towards colder waters.



Familiar cycle linked to the sea

Their mating season varies depending on the availability of food, which is directly related to the cycles of abundance and scarcity in the ocean currents. Females lay between two and three eggs, which they incubate for approximately one month. The chicks are cared by both parents, who take turns incubating the eggs and providing food for the chicks until they can fish for themselves.

Protecting their habitat

The Peruvian pelican face serious threats due to human activity, such as pollution, overfishing and climate change, which alter its habitat and food sources. The conservation of this species is essential to maintain the ecological balance on the coasts of the South American Pacific.



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